

Paul Slater

CV

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For more than three decades I've helped audiences understand complex information through editorial design, creative leadership and, more recently, digital storytelling. While the tools have changed dramatically over the years, the objective has remained the same: create work that informs, engages and endures.

Digital Design Specialist
NZME, Auckland, 2024 - 2026

Designing interactive storytelling, data visualisation, motion graphics and newsroom tools, working closely with journalists, developers and product teams.

- Redesigned the NZ Herald's 2026 election graphics, including a live electorate map and a 3D seating plan of Parliament fed by Electoral Commission results
- Worked with the Herald's product team on the 2026 election policy grid, and on native app versions of my desktop and mobile election graphics
- Design lead on *Whenua: Our Land, Our History*, an interactive on how land passed out of Māori ownership, now widely used as a teaching resource
- Designed the Chart Generator, a newsroom tool that lets journalists create on-brand charts quickly, without specialist design skills
- Use AI as a design and coding partner to prototype and build faster, including the election graphics

Creative Director – Editorial
NZME, Auckland, 2011 - 2024

Responsible for the creative direction of editorial design across NZME's newspaper and newspaper inserted magazine portfolio while leading the organisation's evolution towards richer digital storytelling.

- Led and mentored designers through a rapidly changing newsroom, providing creative direction, feedback and support while maintaining high standards under demanding deadlines
- Launched and redesigned a number of newspaper inserted magazines
- Introduced new digital storytelling formats and workflows
- Developed interactive projects spanning sport, elections, entertainment and data journalism

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Art Director
Rugby News, Auckland, Feb - Oct 2017

A prestigious, high-quality glossy magazine ranging from 100 to 140 pages in size. I was contracted for four editions, during which I led a comprehensive redesign. For the period I was contracted I was responsible for all design, layout, information graphics and artwork as the sole designer.



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Design Editor
Mountain Scene, Queenstown, 2009 - 2011

I moved to New Zealand's South Island to lead the editorial design of Queenstown's award-winning community newspaper. Alongside editorial design, I expanded the role to include advertising, a complete website redesign and ongoing website maintenance.

- Editorial design and feature presentation
- Advertising design
- Website redesign and maintenance
- Contributed to an award-winning publication and website

Design Editor
National Business Review, Auckland, 2007 - 2009

Directed the visual identity of one of New Zealand's leading business publications, combining editorial design, illustration, infographics and feature presentation while helping broaden the publication's editorial offering.

- Refreshed the publication's editorial design
- Launched a new glossy flagship lifestyle magazine built around the NBR Rich List
- Launched several glossy, newspaper inserted magazines
- Expanded the use of infographics and illustration
- Worked closely with editorial leadership on weekly editions

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Graphic Artist and Design Editor – Asia
Financial Times, London & Hong Kong, 1998 - 2007

I joined the Financial Times in London in 1998 as a Graphic Artist, creating editorial graphics, illustrations and page designs for one of the world's most respected newspapers. It was an environment where accuracy, clarity and visual restraint were held to exceptionally high standards, and it fundamentally shaped my approach to editorial design.

In 2003, I relocated to Hong Kong to become Design Editor, Asia, taking responsibility for all editorial design produced by the bureau. The role expanded well beyond newspaper production, encompassing everything from daily pages and ft.com to magazines, special reports and bespoke publications for readers across the Asia-Pacific region. Working across multiple editions, cultures and time zones demanded a collaborative approach and the ability to deliver consistently under tight daily deadlines.

Returning to London in 2006, I rejoined the Graphics Desk with a broader perspective and a greater emphasis on innovation. Alongside day-to-day editorial production, I continued developing new products and visual storytelling approaches inspired by the work undertaken during my time in Hong Kong. The experience of working in two global newsrooms gave me an international perspective that has continued to influence my work throughout my career.



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Graphic Artist
Gemini News Service, London, 1995 - 1998

Created hand-drawn infographics, editorial illustrations, portraits and political cartoons for newspapers across the developing world. Working to a weekly publishing deadline, the role developed my drawing skills, visual storytelling and ability to communicate ideas clearly, before digital design became the industry standard.

Studio Junior
BMP DDB Needham, London, 1995

My first role out of university took me into the fast-paced world of advertising at BMP DDB Needham, one of the UK's major agencies. It was an early introduction to the long hours and high-pressure environment of campaign pitches, with hands-on duties ranging from operating a PMT camera in the darkroom to artworker and general studio support.

Skills

Creative
- Creative Direction
- Editorial and Print Design
- Information Graphics
- Typography
- Illustration
- Motion Graphics

Digital
- Adobe Creative Cloud (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, After Effects)
- Figma
- Blender
- SketchUp
- Claude Code (AI coding partner) - HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Storytelling
- Data Visualisation
- Data Journalism
- Interaction and UX Design
- 3D Visualisation
- Prototyping

References available on request